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FOR A WHILE, it seemed that every morning I walked into the capitol somebody was standing at my desk waiting to tell me about a new problem we hadn't known about before.

It was as if they opened a new drawer at midnight every day and uncovered another crisis.

Cap Weinberger told me the state was facing a deficit of at least $200 million and within two weeks of my inauguration, I had to send a balanced budget to the legislature. Unlike the federal government, California had to have a balanced budget before the fiscal year began each July 1, and the job was up to me.

We imposed a hiring freeze and a ten percent budget cut at all state agencies and did other things we could to slow the hemorrhage of red ink; we sold Pat Brown's state-owned airplane, slashed out-of-state travel by state employees, canceled several construction projects, and stopped buying new automobiles and trucks for the state. But more drastic steps than that were needed, and soon I found myself in an all-out war with the legislature.

Although California's voters had ended eight years of Democratic leadership in the governor's office, they had left the state assembly and state senate in Democratic hands—and the Democrats didn't like a brand-new Republican governor telling them how to spend the taxpayers' money.

With Pat Brown's departure, the most powerful Democrat in Sacramento had become Jesse Unruh, the speaker of the assembly. Called "Big Daddy" because of his girth and reputation as a political manipulator of the smoke-filled-room variety, Unruh was a classic tax-and-spend liberal. He ruled the assembly with an iron hand and had close ties with